

DESIGN REVIEW · 29 SEPTEMBER 2026

Briggs' Book Club

A visual overhaul, in three parts

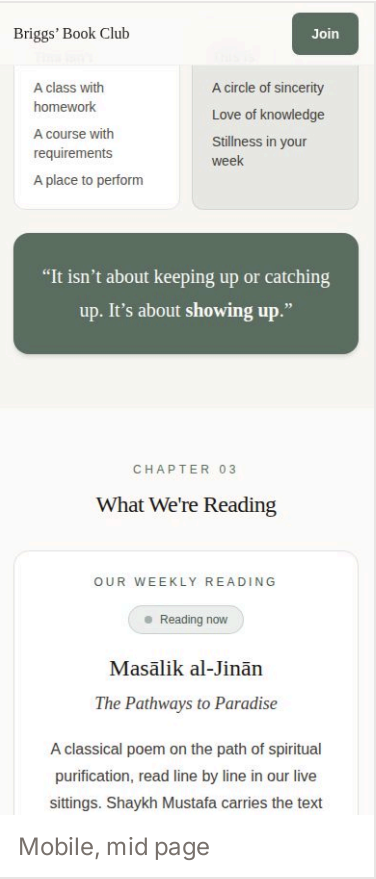
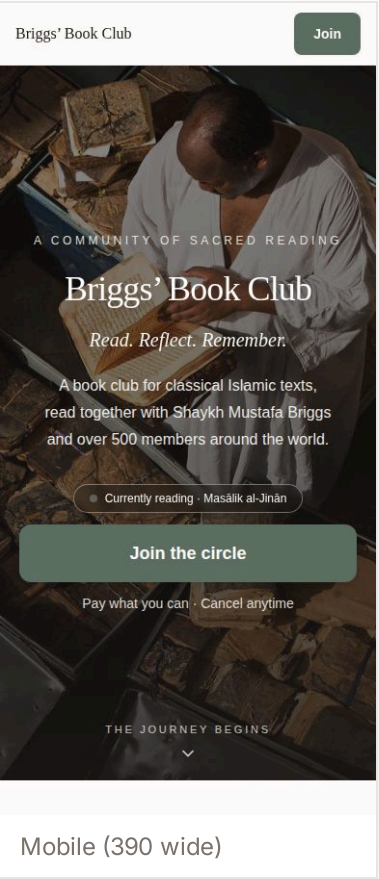
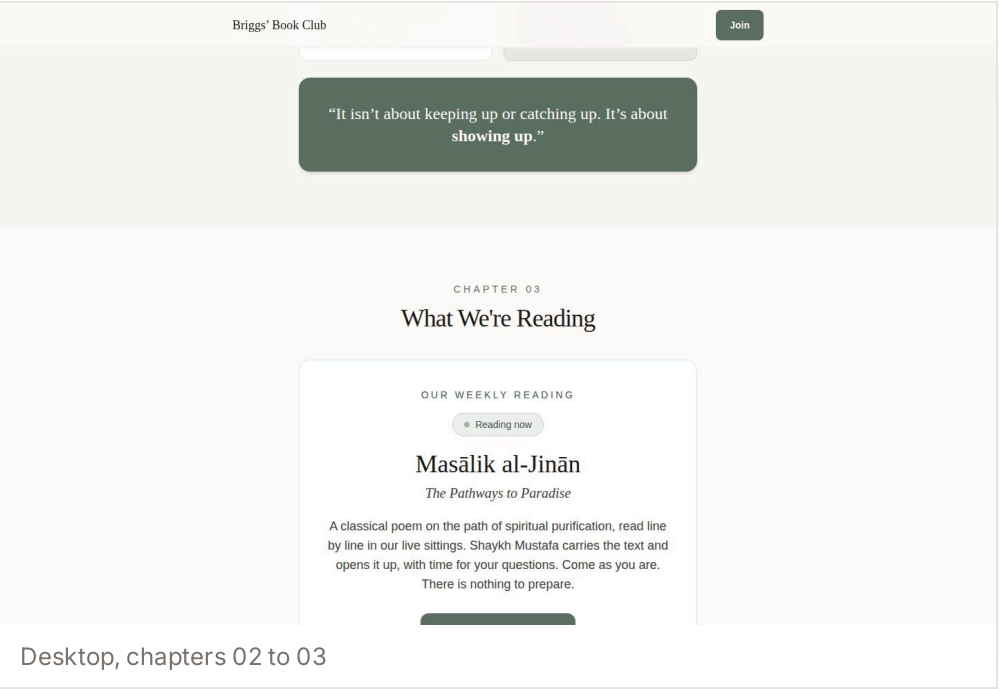
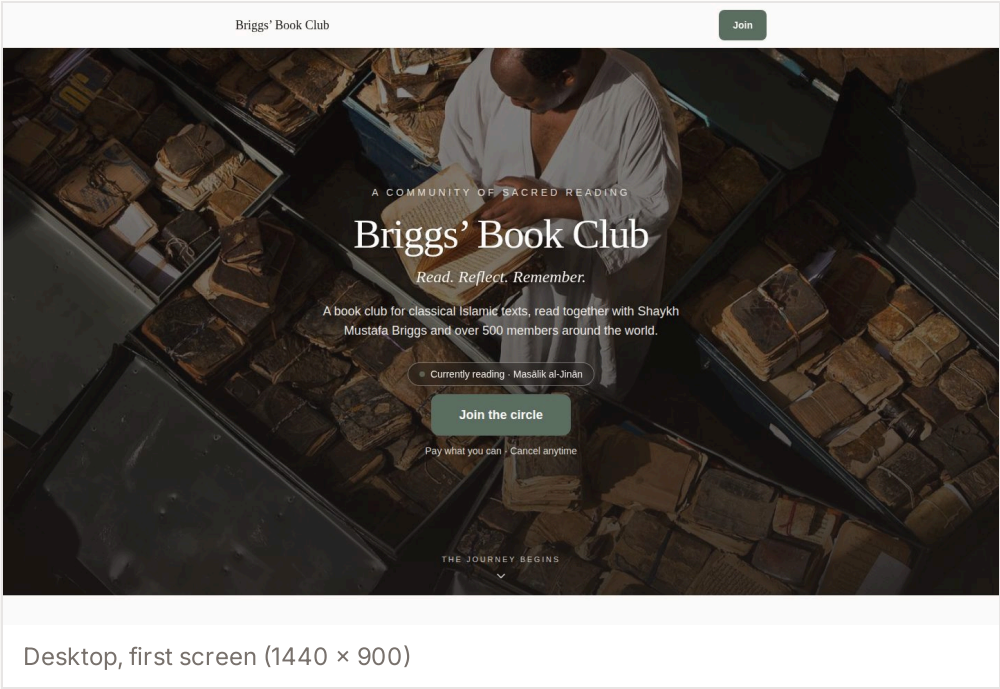
01 What is holding the current site back

02 Concept A · The Manuscript

03 Concept B · The Sanctuary

Both concepts use the new copy in full. Colours, wordmark and photographs are unchanged. Choose one (or a named mix), and it becomes the design system for the build.

The current site, as a visitor sees it



Worth keeping

The palette (cream, warm stone, sage) is calm and right for the subject. The manuscripts photograph is a strong opener. The chaptered storytelling and pay-what-you-can hadiyah model are distinctive. Checkout is short.

The core problem

The page looks like a well-made template rather than a place. Every chapter uses the same centred block, the type has no identity of its own, and the new copy (about two and a half times longer, with transliteration) would turn the current layout into a long grey column.

Major UX and UI issues

HIGH

Typography has no identity, and changes by device

Headings use a system serif stack (lowan Old Style, Palatino). Those fonts ship on Apple devices only, so Android and Windows visitors see Georgia or Times, and body text is Arial or Helvetica. No web fonts are loaded, so the brand looks different on every phone.

→ Load one proper serif family and set a real type scale.

HIGH

Long copy is set centred, in a narrow column

Multi-line paragraphs are centre-aligned sans at 18 to 20px. Centred text is slow to read past two lines. The new chapters 01, 04 and 06 are long, and would read as a wall.

→ Left-align running text, use a reading measure of about 65 characters, and pull out key lines.

HIGH

The Shaykh is a 128px thumbnail

The strongest trust asset on the page is a small circular crop inside a white card. A new visitor never really sees the teacher.

→ Give the portrait real size and a frame that belongs to the brand.

HIGH

Every chapter is the same centred template

Eyebrow, centred H2, centred paragraph, centred card at 576px wide, repeated six times. There is no rhythm and no focal point, and on desktop about 60% of the width sits empty.

→ Give each chapter its own composition within one grid.

HIGH

The hero competes with itself

Eight stacked elements (eyebrow, H1, italic motto, paragraph, pill, button, reassurance, scroll cue) fight for attention over a busy photograph under a 50 to 85% brown overlay that flattens the image.

→ One headline, one paragraph, one call to action, and let the photograph breathe.

MEDIUM

Components look like a software product

Rounded white cards with grey borders, icon stat tiles, pulsing status dots and a green quote box read as a SaaS dashboard, not a circle of sacred reading.

→ Replace with editorial or architectural devices: rules, frames, arches, ornament.

Major UX and UI issues (continued)

MEDIUM

Calls to action are inconsistent

“Join”, “Join the circle”, “Join to attend live” and “Take your seat”, in three button radii, one with a heart icon.

→ One phrase (Take your seat, from the new copy) and one button style.

MEDIUM

Arabic and are left to chance

The honorific and the hadiyah line use whatever Arabic font the device has. On some systems  renders as a dense blob or a box.

→ Load a proper Naskh face (Amiri) for Arabic and the honorific.

LOW

Transliteration needs full glyph coverage

The new copy uses ş, ‘, ħ, đ, ī and more. Several fallback fonts render these with mismatched weights.

→ Choose fonts with Latin Extended Additional coverage (both concepts do).

MEDIUM

No persistent way to join on mobile

After the hero, the only route to the form is the small nav button or scrolling to the very bottom of a long page.

→ A slim sticky call to action on mobile that hides itself at the form.

MEDIUM

Sections barely separate

cream-50 and cream-100 are almost identical on most screens, so chapter changes are hard to see until the sudden switch to dark sage at the hadiyah.

→ Use rules, spacing and one or two deliberate dark moments to pace the page.

LOW

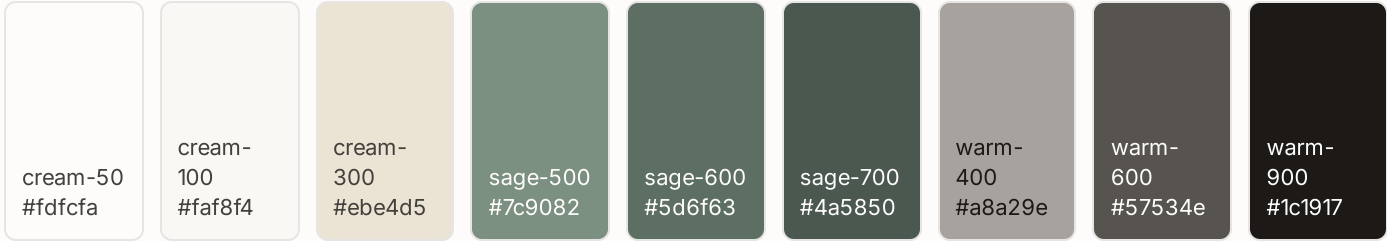
Small polish gaps

A straight apostrophe in “What We're Reading”, no section links in the nav, a thin footer, identical fade-up motion on every element, and share metadata that still describes only Masālik al-Jinān.

→ Fixed during the build.

What stays fixed, and what the concepts may change

Fixed: brand colours (unchanged tokens)



Fixed: photographs and wordmark



Both concepts use only these two images, cropped differently. The wordmark stays “Briggs’ Book Club” in a classical serif.

Free to change

- **Typefaces.** Both concepts move from system fonts to loaded web fonts in the same classical-serif spirit, so the brand looks the same on every device.
- **Layout and grid.** Composition per chapter, alignment, measure, spacing.
- **Components.** Buttons, cards, amount picker, FAQ, lists.
- **Ornament.** Rules, frames, star and arch motifs drawn from the photographs.
- **Motion.** Quieter, slower reveals.

Copy

All new copy is used verbatim across chapters 01 to 08, the hadiyah and the FAQ. Two small additions are layout labels only: step names in chapter 05 (He reads, He explains, You ask) and “First time in English” on the commentary. FAQ answers were not in the new copy, so the current answers are kept, lightly updated to mention the translation. All of this is easy to strip.

The Manuscript

Briggs’ Book Club

THE CHAINTHE TEXTSTHE SHAYKHQUESTIONS

Take your seat

A CIRCLE OF SACRED READING

Briggs’ Book Club

You were never too late for this tradition.

Every week, Shaykh Mustafa Briggs opens a classical Islamic text and reads it, line by line, with more than 500 of us around the world. You don’t need Arabic, there’s nothing to prepare, and nobody here falls behind.

NEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-Abṣār, the life of the Prophet ﷺ in verse, read with a commentary that has never been taught in English before.

Take your seat →

Pay what you can · Cancel anytime



Plate 1. Manuscripts still read, still banded on.

The site as a finely set book. Left-aligned editorial layout, margin chapter numerals, hairline rules and real small caps. It treats the texts with the seriousness of a printed edition and makes long passages a pleasure to read.

Signature moves

- Split hero: text on paper, the manuscripts photograph as a framed “Plate I”
- Large margin numerals (01 to 08) with sticky chapter titles on desktop
- Drop cap, and a transmission line from Madina to Kufa to Tunis to Timbuktu to You
- Qurrat al-Abṣār set as a title page, with the commentary in a dark inset
- Square-cornered buttons with an arrow, underline-style amount field
- Slim sticky “Take your seat” bar on mobile

Type

EB Garamond for everything, with true small caps for labels. Amiri for Arabic and ﷺ.

Live preview (hidden, noindexed): [/concept-manuscript](#)

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAINTHE TEXTSTHE SHAYKHQUESTIONS

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NEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-Aḥḥār, the life of the Prophet ﷺ in verse, read with a commentary that has never been taught in English before.

Take your seat

→

Pay what you can · Cancel anytime



Plate 1. Manuscripts still read, still handled on.

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAINTHE TEXTSTHE SHAYKHQUESTIONS

Take your seat

Read. · Reflect. · Remember.

CHAPTER

01

The Chain

For fourteen centuries this knowledge has travelled from heart to heart: from the Prophet ﷺ to his Companions, from Madina to Kufa, from Tunis to Timbuktu. Scholars call this unbroken chain the *isnād*. It was never built in lecture halls. It was built in small circles, one sitting at a time, by people who kept showing up.

Somewhere along the way, many of us decided that circle was for other people: the ones with Arabic, the ones who studied abroad, the ones who started young.

This circle exists to prove otherwise. The classical texts are still read the way they always were, from a teacher, line by line. And there is a seat for you.

MADINA

KUFA

TUNIS

TIMBUKTU

YOU

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAINTHE TEXTSTHE SHAYKHQUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

02

Who This Circle Is For

This is for you if

- you've always meant to read the classical texts and never known where to begin
- you've started a course before and quietly dropped off when life got busy
- you don't read Arabic, or you read it slowly
- you'd rather learn one line deeply than skim a hundred pages
- you want one still place in your week that belongs to your heart

This isn't for you if you want certificates, exams or somewhere to prove what you know. There are good places for those. This circle is for something slower.

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAINTHE TEXTSTHE SHAYKHQUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

03

What We Believe

Read

the text together.

Reflect

on what it asks of you.

Remember

Allah, and the people who carried this knowledge to us.

THIS ISN'T

A class with homework

A course with requirements

A place to perform

THIS IS

A circle of sincerity

Love of knowledge

Stillness in your week

“It isn't about keeping up or catching up. It's about showing up.”

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAIN

THE TEXTS

THE SHAYKH

QUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

04

What We're Reading

BEGINNING

NEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-Abṣār

Qurrat al-Abṣār fī sirat al-mushaffā' al-mukhtār

A poem on the life of the Prophet ﷺ

An *arjūza* like this is not a summary. It compresses the whole life of the Prophet ﷺ into rhyming couplets, so the student carries the sira in memory rather than on a shelf. From there, it is ready for a khutba, a class or a majlis, and any line can be opened up at length.

more than thirty times and wrote across many fields, including an *Alfiyya* in grammar. He finished this poem in Madina more than five hundred years ago, and it is what carried his name across the desert. It has been memorised and taught in the *maḥḍara* ever since, and remains one of the standard sira texts of the West African and Saharan curriculum, alongside works like the *Alfiyya* of al-'Irāqī.

FIRST TIME IN ENGLISH

A commentary that came by hand

We read the poem with *Bughyat al-Abrār min Sharḥ Qurrat al-Abṣār*, by the

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAIN

THE TEXTS

THE SHAYKH

QUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

04

What We're Reading

Mustafa a copy himself, with permission to teach it and translate it.

It has never been taught or published in English before. You will receive the translation in instalments as we go.

CONTINUING

Masālik al-Jinān

The Pathways to Paradise, by Shaykh Abmadu Bamba
We carry on with the poem on the path of spiritual purification, with its translation still arriving in instalments.

CHAPTER

05

You don't need to prepare anything. You only need to arrive.

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAIN

THE TEXTS

THE SHAYKH

QUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

05

How a Sitting Works

Then the floor is yours, and you can ask whatever you like.

i.

HE READS

The Arabic, aloud, as it has always been read.

ii.

HE EXPLAINS

In English, line by line, from the Qur'an, the Sunnah and the chain.

iii.

YOU ASK

The floor is yours. Ask whatever you like.

Every sitting is recorded and kept in the replay library.

CHAPTER

06

The One Who



Shaykh Mustafa Briggs

Mustafa has taught at more than 50 universities, including Oxford, Cambridge, Harvard and Yale, and wrote the Amazon bestseller *Beyond Bilal: Black History in Islam*. He studied at SOAS and al-Azhar

Briggs' Book Club

THE CHAIN

THE TEXTS

THE SHAYKH

QUESTIONS

Take your seat

CHAPTER

06

The One Who Opens the Book



Plate II. Shaykh Mustafa at a sitting.

Through those *ijazat*, the texts reach you the way they always have, from teacher to student. Every week, he sits down to read with us.

50+ UNIVERSITIES

BEYOND BILAL

SOAS · AL-AZHAR

CLASSICAL IJAZAT

CHAPTER

07

The Company You Keep

The Prophet ﷺ taught through subbah, companionship. The book is why we gather. Each other is why we stay.

500+

READERS WORLDWIDE

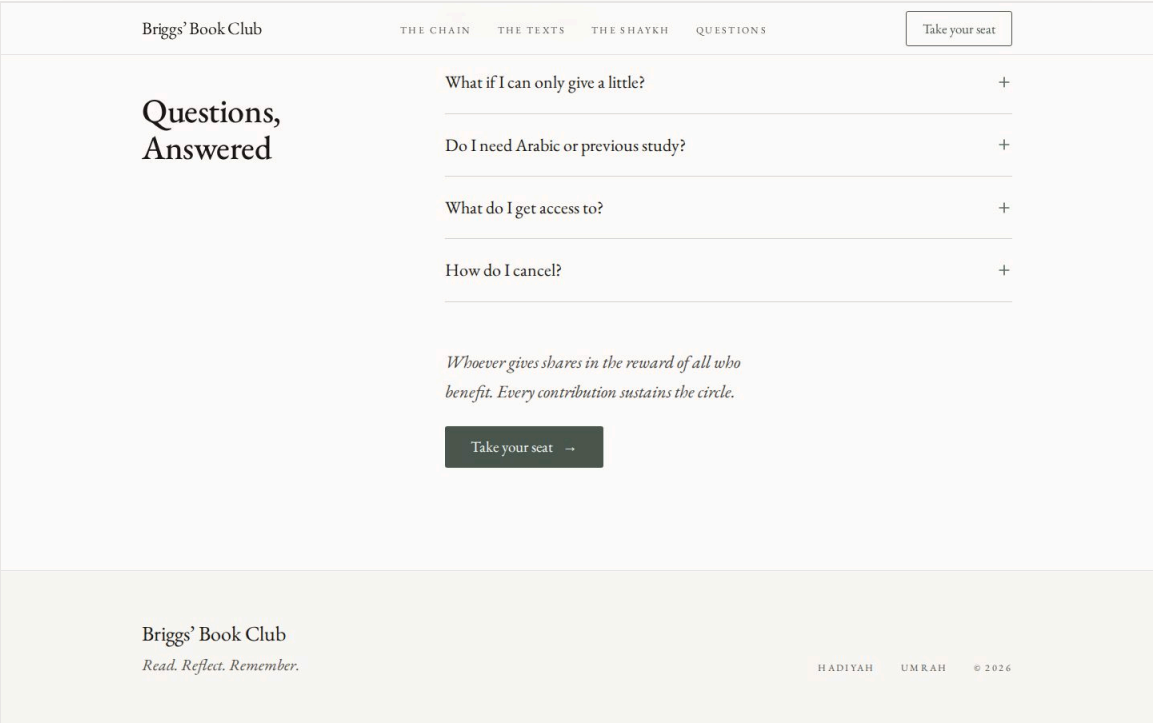
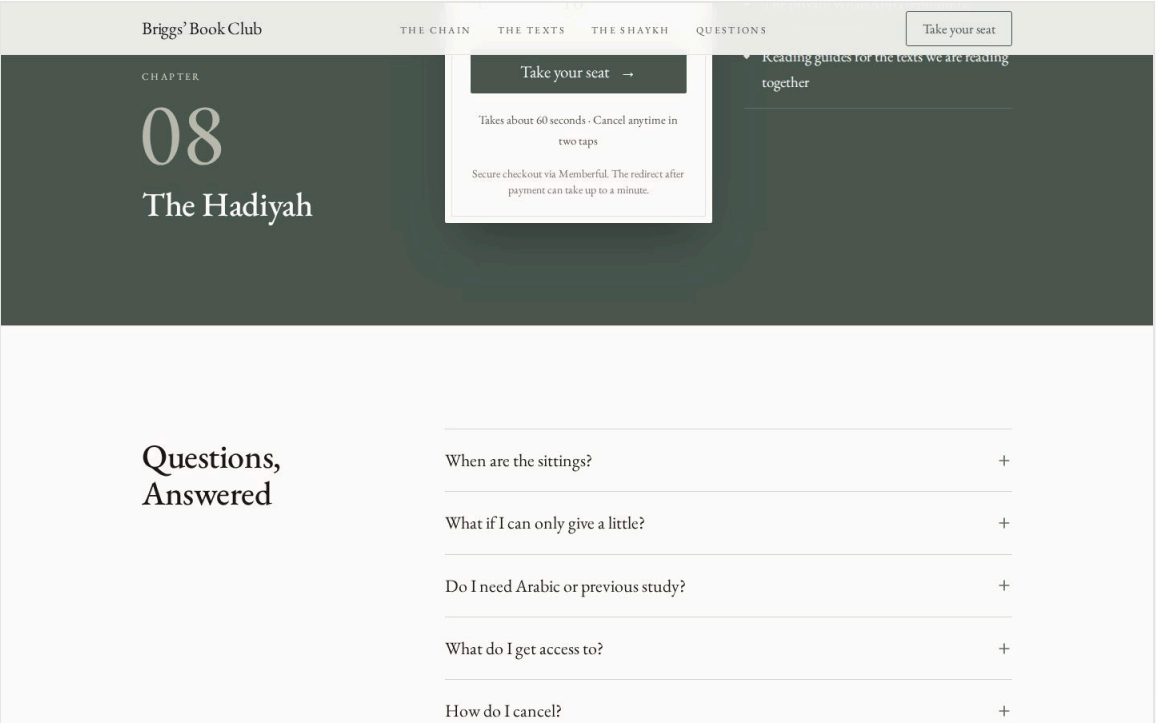
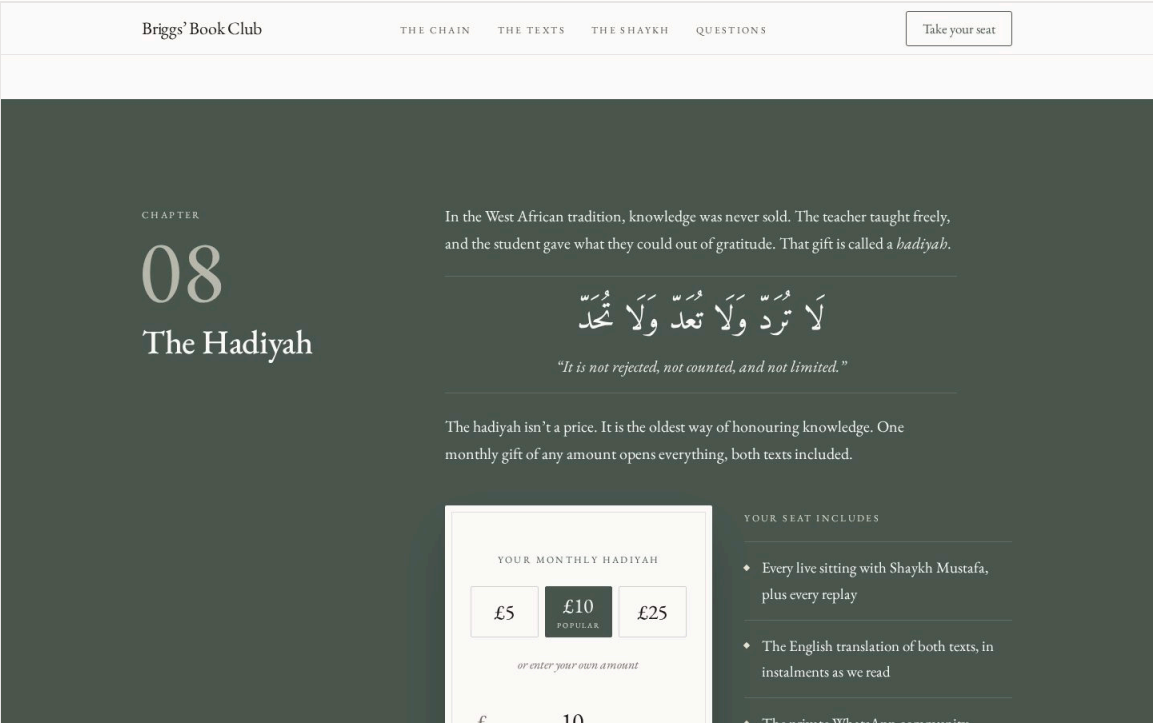
Live

ALL RECORDED

WhatsApp

MEMBER CIRCLE

Desktop, 1440 wide · 3 of 3



Mobile, 390 wide · 1 of 3

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat



Plate 1. Manuscripts still read, still handed on.

A CIRCLE OF SACRED READING

Briggs’ Book Club

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Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

Qurrat al-ʿabshār, we hope you’ll enjoy this verse, read with a commentary that has never been taught in English before.

Take your seat →

Pay what you can · Cancel anytime

Read. ♦ Reflect. ♦ Remember.

CHAPTER

01

The Chain

For fourteen centuries this knowledge has travelled from heart to heart: from the Prophet ﷺ to his Companions, from Madina to Kufa, from Tunis to Timbuktu.

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

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MADINA KUFĀ TUNIS TIMBUKTU YOU

CHAPTER

02

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

This is for you if

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Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

CHAPTER

03

What We Believe

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the text together.

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Remember

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Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

requirements

A place to perform

♦

“It isn’t about keeping up or catching up. It’s about showing up.”

♦

CHAPTER

04

What We’re Reading

Two texts, one circle.

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

Qurrat al-ʿAbshār

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A poem on the life of the Prophet ﷺ

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The poet, ‘Abd al-‘Azīz b. ‘Abd al-Wāhid al-Lamṭī al-Miknāsī, studied in Fes and settled in Madina. He performed the hajj more than thirty times and wrote across many fields, including an *Alfiyya* in grammar. He finished this poem in Madina more than five hundred years ago.

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

African and Saharan curriculum, alongside works like the *Alfiyya* of al-‘Irāqī.

FIRST TIME IN ENGLISH

A commentary that came by hand

We read the poem with *Bughyat al-Abnār min Sharḥ Qurnat al-Abṣār*, by the late Shaykh Muḥammad al-Ḥasan b. Aḥmad al-Khadīm of Taysir, Mauritania, *rahimahullāb*, who passed away in Rabī‘ al-Awwal 1448. He gave Shaykh Mustafa a copy himself, with permission to teach it and translate it.

It has never been taught or published in English before. You will receive the translation in instalments as we go.

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

The Pathways to Paradise, by Shaykh Ahmadu Bamba

We carry on with the poem on the path of spiritual purification, with its translation still arriving in instalments.

CHAPTER

05

How a Sitting Works

You don’t need to prepare anything. You only need to arrive.

CHAPTER

06

The One Who Opens the Book



Plate II. Shaykh Mustafa at a sitting.

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

i.

HE READS

The Arabic, aloud, as it has always been read.

ii.

HE EXPLAINS

In English, line by line, from the Qur’an, the Sunnah and the chain.

iii.

YOU ASK

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Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

They and wrote the famous treatise beyond Bilal: Black History in Islam. He studied at SOAS and al-Azhar and holds classical *ijazat* from Shariff Ibrahim Ibn Saleh al-Hussaini.

Through those *ijazat*, the texts reach you the way they always have, from teacher to student. Every week, he sits down to read with us.

50+ UNIVERSITIES

BEYOND BILAL

SOAS · AL-AZHAR

CLASSICAL IJAZAT

CHAPTER

07

The Company You Keep

The Prophet ﷺ taught through

Pay what you can. Cancel anytime.

Take your seat →

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

500+ READERS WORLDWIDE

Live ALL RECORDED

WhatsApp MEMBER CIRCLE

People like us read the classics slowly, together, and keep coming back.

CHAPTER

08

The Hadiyah

In the West African tradition, knowledge was never sold. The teacher taught freely, and the student gave what they could out of gratitude. That gift is called a *hadiyah*.

Briggs’ Book Club

Take your seat

“It is not rejected, not counted, and not limited.”

The *hadiyah* isn’t a price. It is the oldest way of honouring knowledge. One monthly gift of any amount opens everything, both texts included.

YOUR MONTHLY HADIYAH

£5

£10 POPULAR

£25

or enter your own amount

£

10

Take your seat →

Takes about 60 seconds · Cancel anytime in two taps

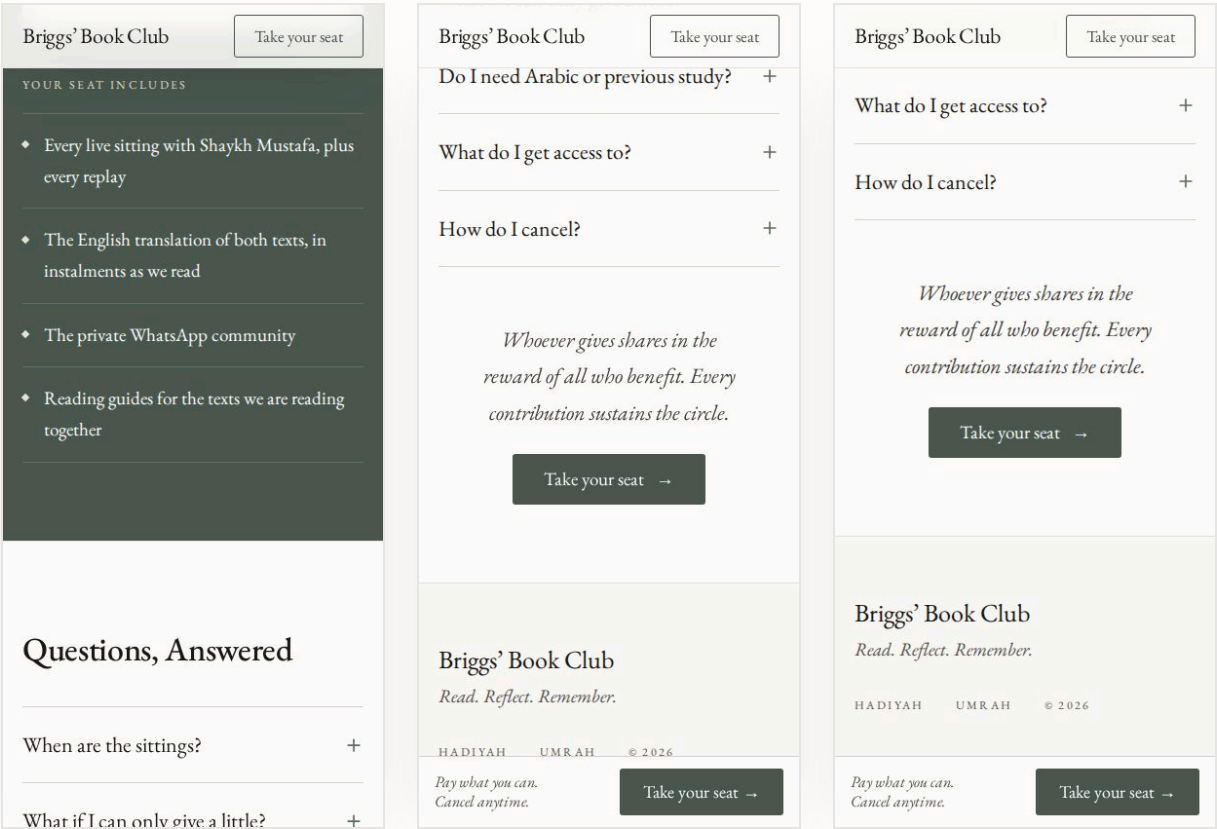
Secure checkout via Memberful. The redirect after payment can take up to a minute.

Briggs’ Book Club · Visual overhaul

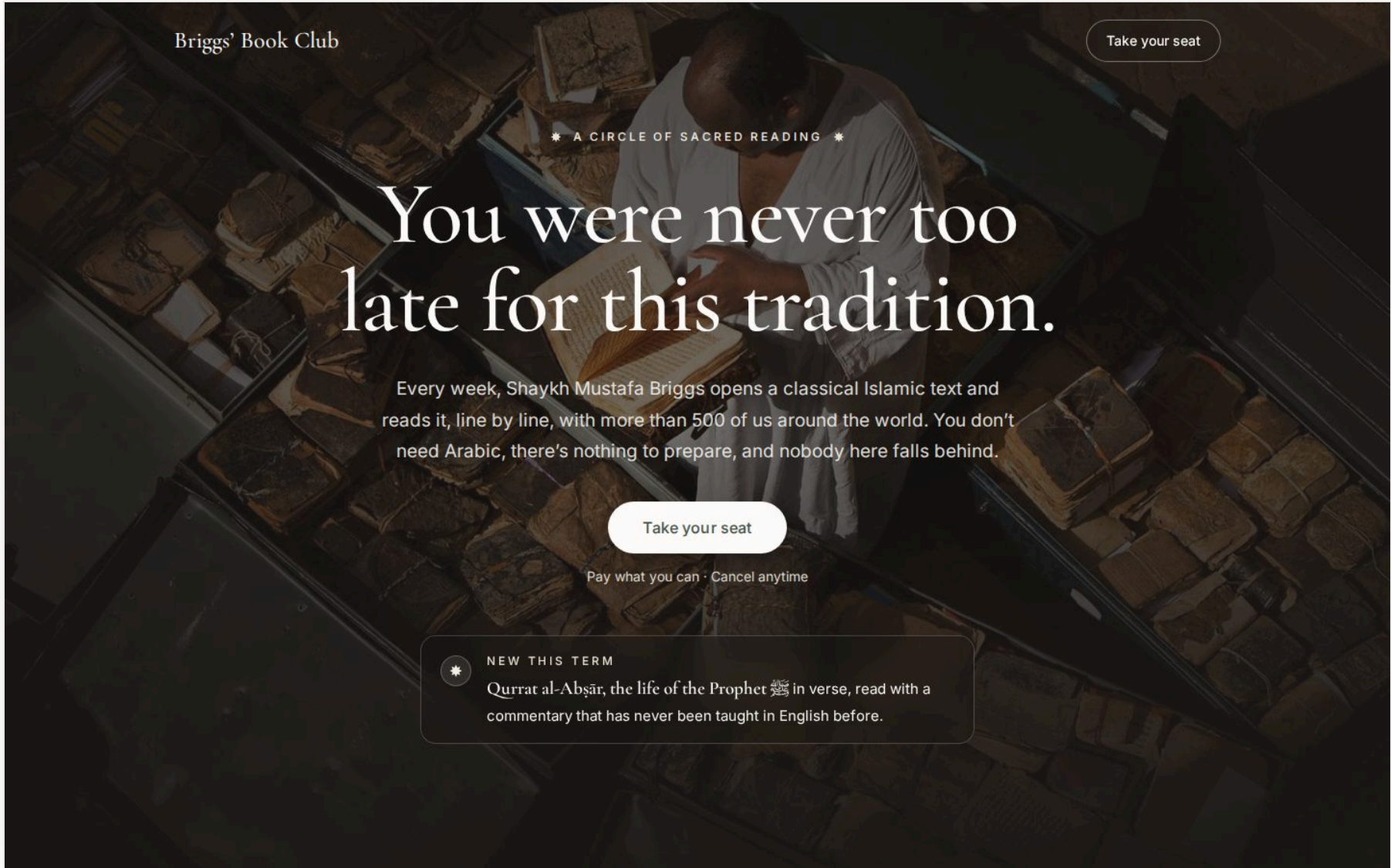
Concept A

11

Mobile, 390 wide · 3 of 3



The Sanctuary



The site as a quiet, beautiful room. Immersive photography, centred compositions and two shapes drawn from the pictures: the mihrab arch and the circle of the halaqa. It leads with the emotional promise and feels warm and welcoming.

Signature moves

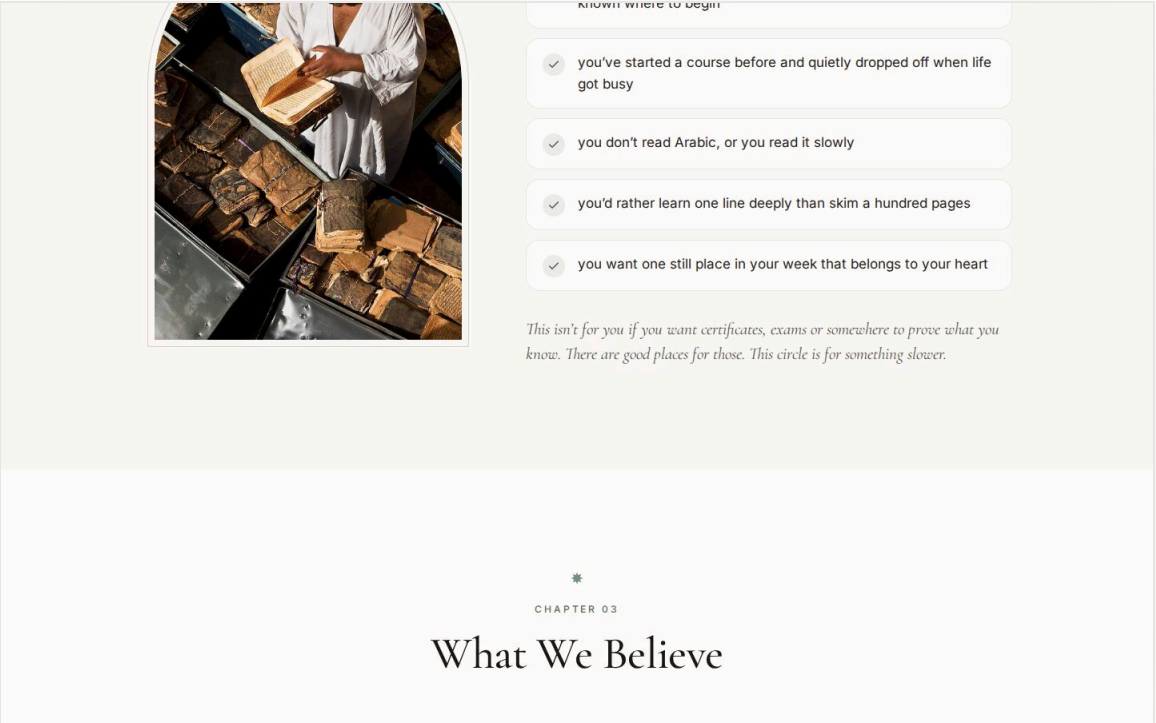
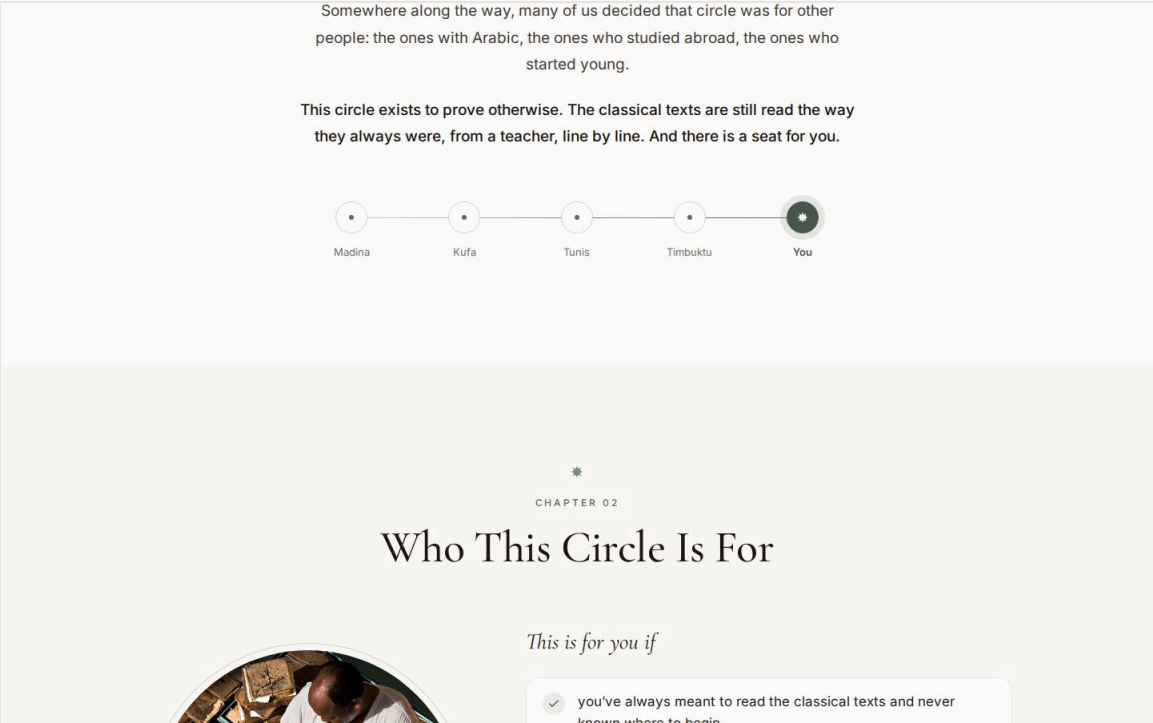
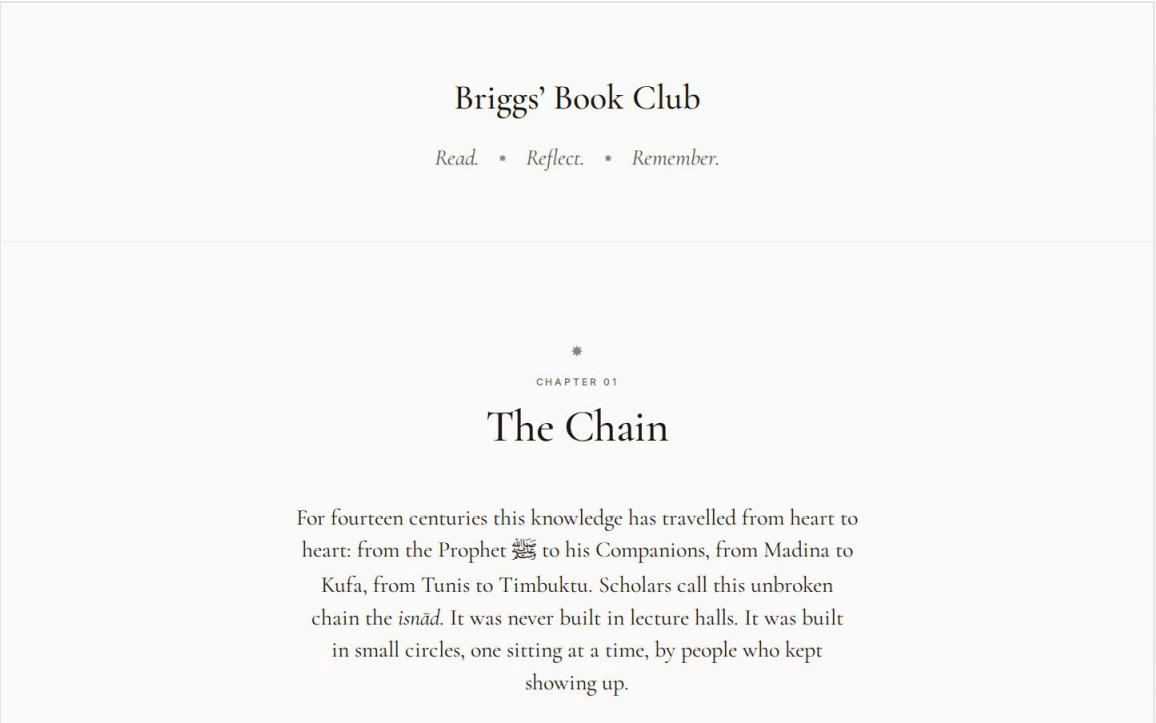
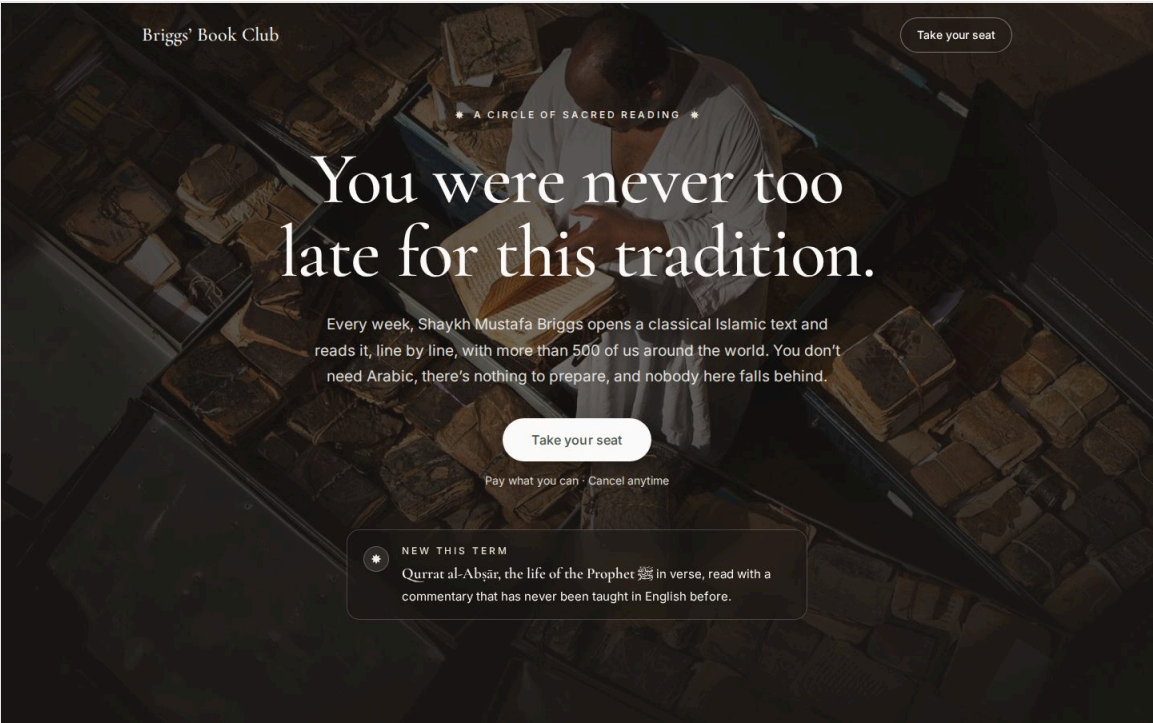
- Full-bleed hero that leads with “You were never too late for this tradition.”
- Arch-framed portrait of the Shaykh, and arch-shaped Read / Reflect / Remember tiles
- Eight-point star ornament taken from the lattice behind the Shaykh
- Qurrat al-Abṣār as a dark feature card, the commentary as a cream inset
- Circles for the sitting steps and the community stats
- Pill buttons and a floating pill call to action on mobile

Type

Cormorant Garamond for display, Inter for reading text. Amiri for Arabic and ﷺ.

Live preview (hidden, noindexed): [/concept-sanctuary](#)

Desktop, 1440 wide · 1 of 4



Desktop, 1440 wide · 2 of 4

*

Read

the text together.

*

Reflect

on what it asks of you.

*

Remember

Allah, and the people who carried this knowledge to us.

THIS ISN'T

A class with homework

A course with requirements

A place to perform

THIS IS

A circle of sincerity

Love of knowledge

Stillness in your week

“It isn’t about keeping up or catching up. It’s about showing up.”

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CONTINUING

Masālik al-Jinān

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*

*

CHAPTER 04

What We’re Reading

Two texts, one circle.

BEGINNING NEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-Abṣār

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A poem on the life of the Prophet ﷺ

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* FIRST TIME IN ENGLISH

A commentary that came by hand

CHAPTER 05

How a Sitting Works

You don’t need to prepare anything. You only need to arrive.

Shaykh Mustafa reads the Arabic, then explains it in English, line by line. He carries the text for us, drawing on the Qur’an, the Sunnah and the living chain of *isnād*. Then the floor is yours, and you can ask whatever you like.

1

He reads

The Arabic, aloud, as it has always been read.

2

He explains

In English, line by line, from the Qur’an, the Sunnah and the chain.

3

You ask

The floor is yours. Ask whatever you like.

© Every sitting is recorded and kept in the replay library.

Desktop, 1440 wide · 3 of 4

CHAPTER 06

The One Who Opens the Book



YOUR TEACHER

Shaykh Mustafa Briggs

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50+ universities

Beyond Bilal

SOAS - al-Azhar

Classical ijazat

CHAPTER 07

The Company You Keep

The Prophet ﷺ taught through suhbah, companionship. The book is why we gather. Each other is why we stay.

500+
readers worldwide

Live
all recorded

WhatsApp
member circle

People like us read the classics slowly, together, and keep coming back.

CHAPTER 08

The Hadiyah

In the West African tradition, knowledge was never sold. The teacher taught freely, and the student gave what they could out of gratitude. That gift is called a *hadiyah*.

لَا تُرَدُّ وَلَا تُعَدُّ وَلَا تُحَدُّ

"It is not rejected, not counted, and not limited."

The hadiyah isn't a price. It is the oldest way of honouring knowledge. One monthly gift of any amount opens everything, both texts included.

Your monthly hadiyah

£10

£5

£10
POPULAR

£25

or enter your own amount

£

10

Take your seat

Takes about 60 seconds - Cancel anytime in two taps

Secure checkout via Memberful. The redirect after payment can take up to a minute.

YOUR SEAT INCLUDES

✓ Every live sitting with Shaykh Mustafa, plus every replay

✓ The English translation of both texts, in instalments as we read

✓ The private WhatsApp community

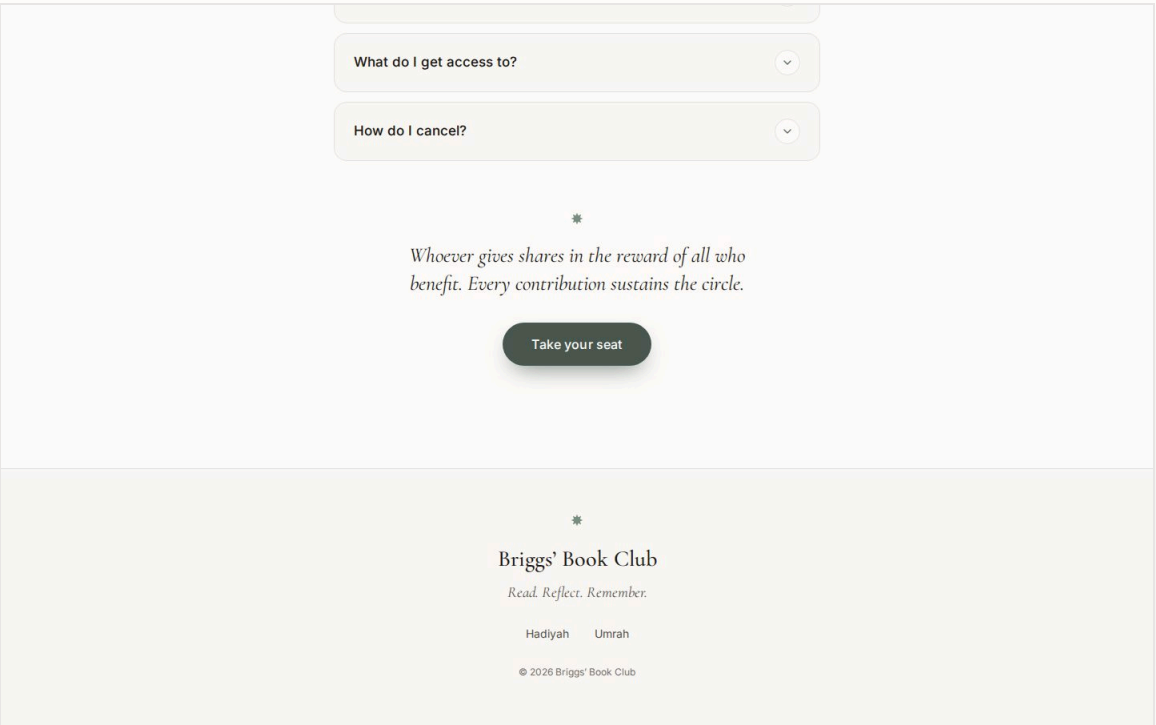
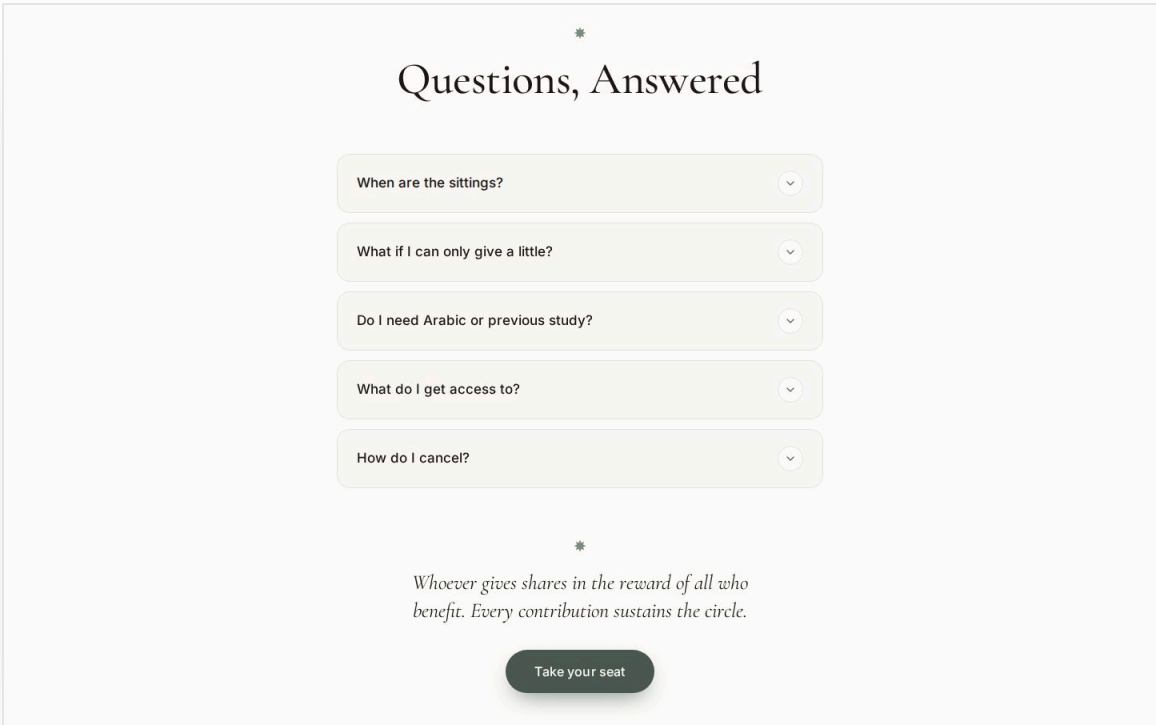
✓ Reading guides for the texts we are reading together

Briggs' Book Club · Visual overhaul

Concept B

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Briggs' Book Club

Take your seat

A CIRCLE OF SACRED READING

You were never too late for this tradition.

Every week, Shaykh Mustafa Briggs opens a classical Islamic text and reads it, line by line, with more than 500 of us around the world. You don't need Arabic, there's nothing to prepare, and nobody here falls behind.

Take your seat

Pay what you can · Cancel anytime

NEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-Abṣār, the life of the Prophet ﷺ in verse, read with a commentary that has never been taught in English before.

Briggs' Book Club

Read. · Reflect. · Remember.

CHAPTER 01

The Chain

For fourteen centuries this knowledge has travelled from heart to heart: from the Prophet ﷺ to his Companions, from Madina to Kufa, from Tunis to Timbuktu. Scholars call this unbroken chain the *isnād*. It was never built in lecture halls. It was built in small circles, one sitting at a time, by people who kept

showing up.

Somewhere along the way, many of us decided that circle was for other people: the ones with Arabic, the ones who studied abroad, the ones who started young.

This circle exists to prove otherwise. The classical texts are still read the way they always were, from a teacher, line by line. And there is a seat for you.

MadinaKufaTunisTimbuktuYou

CHAPTER 02

Pay what you canTake your seat

got busy

you don't read Arabic, or you read it slowly

you'd rather learn one line deeply than skim a hundred pages

you want one still place in your week that belongs to your heart

This isn't for you if you want certificates, exams or somewhere to prove what you know. There are good places for those. This circle is for something slower.

CHAPTER 03

Pay what you canTake your seat

Read

the text together.

Reflect

on what it asks of you.

Remember

Allah, and the people who carried this knowledge to us.

Pay what you canTake your seat

A class with homework

A course with requirements

A place to perform

THIS IS

A circle of sincerity

Love of knowledge

Stillness in your week

"It isn't about keeping up or catching up. It's about showing up."

Pay what you canTake your seat

CHAPTER 04

What We're Reading

Two texts, one circle.

BEGINNINGNEW THIS TERM

Qurrat al-
Abṣār

Qurrat al-Abṣār fī sirat al-mushaffa' al-mukhtar

A poem on the life of the Prophet ﷺ

An *arjūza* like this is not a summary. It compresses the whole life of the Prophet ﷺ into rhyming couplets, so the student carries the sira in memory rather than on a shelf. From there, it is ready for a khutba, a class or a majlis, and any line can be opened up at length.

Pay what you can

Take your seat

Wahid al-Lamti al-Miknasi, studied in

Fes and settled in Madina. He performed the ḥajj more than thirty times and wrote across many fields, including an *Alfiyya* in grammar. He finished this poem in Madina more than five hundred years ago, and it is what carried his name across the desert. It has been memorised and taught in the *maḥḍara* ever since, and remains one of the standard sira texts of the West African and Saharan curriculum, alongside works like the *Alfiyya* of al-'Irāqī.

* FIRST TIME IN ENGLISH

A commentary that came by hand

We read the poem with *Bughyat al-Abrār min Sharḥ Qurrat al-Abṣār*, by the late Shaykh Muḥammad al-Ḥasan b. Aḥmad al-Khadīm of Taysir, Mauritania, *raḥimahullāh*, who passed away in Rabī' al-Awwal

Pay what you can

Take your seat

to teach it and translate it.

It has never been taught or published in English before. You will receive the translation in instalments as we go.

CONTINUING

Masālik al-Jinān

The Pathways to Paradise, by Shaykh Ahmadu Bamba

We carry on with the poem on the path of spiritual purification, with its translation still arriving in instalments.

Pay what you can

Take your seat

CHAPTER 05

How a Sitting Works

You don't need to prepare anything. You only need to arrive.

Shaykh Mustafa reads the Arabic, then explains it in English, line by line. He carries the text for us, drawing on the Qur'an, the Sunnah and the living chain of *ishād*. Then the floor is yours, and you can ask whatever you like.

1

He reads

The Arabic, aloud, as it has always been read.

2

He explains

Pay what you can

Take your seat

In English, line by line, from the Qur'an, the Sunnah and the chain.

3

You ask

The floor is yours. Ask whatever you like.

Every sitting is recorded and kept in the replay library.

* CHAPTER 06

The One Who Opens the Book

Pay what you can

Take your seat



YOUR TEACHER

Shaykh Mustafa Briggs

Mustafa has taught at more than 50 universities, including Oxford, Cambridge, Harvard and Yale, and wrote the Amazon bestseller *Beyond Bilal: Black History in*

Pay what you can

Take your seat

Ibrahim Ibn Saleh al-Hussaini.

Through those *ijazat*, the texts reach you the way they always have, from teacher to student. Every week, he sits down to read with us.

50+ universities

Beyond Bilal

SOAS · al-Azhar

Classical ijazat

* CHAPTER 07

The Company You Keep

The Prophet ﷺ taught through *suhbah*, companionship. The book is why we gather.

Pay what you can

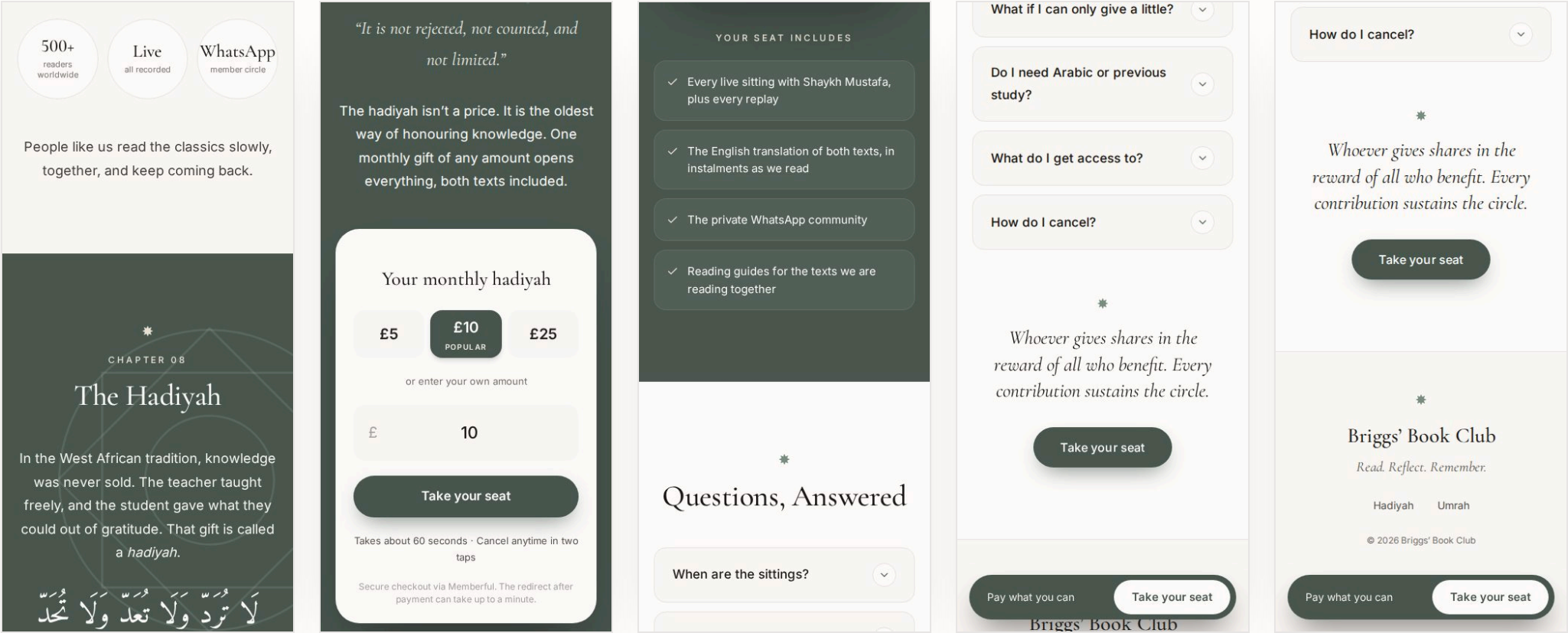
Take your seat

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Side by side

	A · The Manuscript	B · The Sanctuary
Feeling	Scholarly, calm, a printed edition	Warm, immersive, a sacred room
Hero leads with	The name, then the promise	The promise, with the name as eyebrow
Long passages	Best in class: serif body, left-aligned, columns	Good: sans body, generous spacing, centred intros
First impression on mobile	Photograph, then title	Photograph behind a large headline and CTA
The Shaykh	Framed plate beside the biography	Large arched portrait, shadowed
Components	Square, hairline, typographic	Rounded, pill, soft shadow
Risk	Could feel formal to someone who feels “too late”	More decorative; needs restraint as content grows
Best if you want	Authority and the texts front and centre	Welcome and conversion front and centre

MY RECOMMENDATION

B, The Sanctuary. The new copy is written to someone who assumes the circle is not for them. B answers that on the first screen, is the more welcoming of the two, and has the stronger mobile path to the form. If you love A's reading typography, a named mix works well: B's structure and hero with A's EB Garamond body for the long chapters.

What happens after you choose

1. You pick	A, B, or a named mix (for example, “B, with A’s chain line and drop cap”). Any notes on specific sections are welcome.
2. Design system	I turn the chosen direction into tokens and components in the codebase: type scale, spacing, colour roles over the existing palette, buttons, cards, section layouts, ornament, motion, and the amount picker. Documented in the repo.
3. Build	The live home page is rebuilt on that system with the new copy, plus the navigation, footer and share metadata (title, description, preview card for Qurrat al-Abṣār).
4. Check	Desktop and mobile review, accessibility pass (contrast, focus, headings, reduced motion), and the Memberful checkout still works end to end.

The concept pages live at /concept-manuscript and /concept-sanctuary on the branch preview. They are not linked from the site, carry a noindex tag and are disallowed in robots.txt. They are removed once the chosen design ships.